Figure 6.4 Camera routing for performance

DEFINITION A *routing strategy* is the logic that selects the final destination of a sent message.

You can use Akka's built-in router functionality to implement this type of router. In Akka, a separation is made between the router, which contains the routing logic, and the actor, which represents the router. The router logic decides which routee is selected and can be used within an actor to make a selection. The router actor is self-contained and uses the routing logic to manage the routees.

The built-in routers are available in two variants:

- *Pool*—These routers manage the routees. They are responsible for creating routees and removing them from the list when they stop. A pool can be used when all routees are created in place and do not yet exist. It is important to know that—like any other actor—a routee is stopped by default, but usually it is better to set it to restart.
- *Group*—The group routers do not create routees. The routees must be created somewhere in the application, and the group router uses the receptionist to find them. A group router can be used if you need to control the lifecycles of the routees, meaning where and how they are instantiated.

Figure 6.5 shows the actor hierarchy of routees and the differences between using a pool and a group router. With a pool, the routees are children of the router, whereas with a group router, routees can be children of any other actor. They only need to be up and running.